

You should see the version number displayed, confirming that Python is installed correctly.

Pip: Your Package Manager

Along with Python, you've also installed pip, which stands for "Pip Installs Packages." This is Python's official package manager—a tool that allows you to easily install and manage additional Python libraries.

To verify pip is working correctly, run:

```
pip --version
```

You should see the pip version number, confirming it's ready to use.

Choosing a Development Environment: Where the Magic Happens

Now that Python is installed, you need a comfortable place to write your code. While you could use a basic text editor, a specialized Integrated Development Environment (IDE) will dramatically improve your productivity.

Think of an IDE as the difference between cooking in a professional kitchen versus a camping stove. Both can produce meals, but the professional kitchen offers specialized tools that make complex dishes easier to prepare.

Visual Studio Code: The Versatile Choice

Visual Studio Code (VS Code) has become one of the most popular IDEs for Python development, used by companies like Microsoft's own quantitative finance teams and many fintech startups.